EXPERIMENT & TEST PLAN

BeReal Passport & Community Boards — Test Plan

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> *Independent concept created for a UI/UX Design & Product Management Externship. Not affiliated with or endorsed by BeReal.*

Summary

The 5-person focus group gave a directional signal: **4 of 5** would open BeReal more often, and the main friction was **too many taps from capture to stamp**. Five people can find usability problems, but they can't prove that a feature changes behavior.

This plan tests the feature in two stages before any wide rollout:

Stage	PRD phase	Question it answers	Method
1. Usability retest	Phase 1: refine & retest	Did the redesign fix the friction?	Moderated usability test, 7–10 people
2. A/B experiment	Phase 2: MVP	Does the feature make casual users come back more, without hurting regular posting?	Randomized controlled experiment

The decision this plan supports: **ship to full rollout (Phase 3), iterate, or kill.**

Stage 1: Usability retest

Goal: confirm the refined flow is simple enough before spending engineering time on an MVP.

Participants: 7–10 people, including **at least 3 lapsed or non-users**. The first round had only one non-user, and that person raised the "overly complex" concern.

Tasks: the same three tasks as the interactive job aid, unaided:

1. Post a stamped BeReal to a board
2. Find your stamp in your Passport and open the capsule
3. Opt out of one board in Settings

Measures and pass criteria:

Measure	Baseline (round 1)	Pass criteria
Task 1 completed without help	Not measured	**≥ 80%** of participants

Measure	Baseline (round 1)	Pass criteria
Taps from shutter to stamped post	**4** (shutter → COMMUNITY BOARD → pick board → Stamp & post)	**≤ 3**
Time from capture to stamped post	Not measured	Median **≤ 15 seconds**
Ease of Task 1 (1–7 single-ease question)	Not measured	Median **≥ 6**
"Reminders and streak feel low-pressure" (1–5)	**4.2**	**≥ 4.0** (hold the gain)
"I'd open BeReal more often"	**4 of 5**	**≥ 70%**
"Overly complex" raised unprompted	1 of 5	**≤ 1** participant

If it fails: iterate on the design and retest before moving to Stage 2.

Stage 2: A/B experiment

Hypothesis

> **If** casual BeReal users can post their daily photo to a themed squad board and earn a collectible Real Passport stamp, **then** they will be active on more days, **because** boards give them a reason to return that adds no time pressure.

- **Null hypothesis (H_0):** active days per user are the same in treatment and control.
- **Secondary hypotheses:**
- Better day-7 and day-30 retention.
- No drop in regular posting (the feature adds to the core habit rather than replacing it).

Who is in the test

- **Eligible:** users with at least one squad of 3+ friends, on an app version that supports boards.
- **Primary segment: casual users**, active on 1–12 of the last 28 days. They're the users the feature is designed to win back.
- **Also reported:** all users and daily users, as a check that the feature doesn't hurt the most engaged users.

How users are randomized

Decision	Choice	Why
Unit of randomization	The **squad (friend cluster)**, not the individual user	Boards are social. If one friend has boards and another doesn't, they influence each other and contaminate the results.

Decision	Choice	Why
How clusters are formed	Friend-graph communities, frozen at the start of the test	Keeps each squad entirely in one group
Split	**50 / 50**, stratified by squad size and baseline activity	Balances the groups on the factors most likely to affect results
Treatment	Community Boards, stamps, Passport, Squad Stamp Tally and opt-in prompts	The full MVP loop
Control	Standard BeReal, with the same number of notifications	Rules out "more notifications" as the cause
Analysis	**Intent-to-treat**: compare everyone *assigned*, not only users who opted in	Opt-in users are self-selected and would overstate the effect. Opt-in rate is reported separately.

Metrics

Primary metric (one, decided in advance):

Metric	Definition	Why this one
Active days per casual user	Days with at least one app open in a 28-day window	Measures directly whether the feature brings people back. It is the building block of DAU/MAU, the North Star.

Secondary metrics:

Metric	What it tells us
Day-7 and day-30 retention	Whether the effect lasts beyond the novelty
Sessions per user per day	Progress toward the PRD's 2.5x daily-opens goal
Board opt-in rate	Adoption; an effect needs enough people to join
Share of posts sent to a board	Feature usage
Passport and Squad Stamp Tally visits	Whether the collection loop is pulling people back
Taps and time from capture to stamped post	Usability at scale

Guardrail metrics (these must not get worse):

Guardrail	Threshold to stop or kill
Regular (SEND) posts per user	Drop of **more than 2%**
Total BeReals posted per user	Any significant drop
Notification disable rate	Increase of **more than 10%**
Uninstall rate	Any significant increase
Board opt-out rate	Above **20%** of joiners within 14 days

Guardrail	Threshold to stop or kill
Report and block rate on board posts	Any significant increase
Post failures (error state) and crashes	Above the current app baseline
"Still feels like BeReal" (in-app survey, 1–5)	Below **3.5**

Sample size and duration

The numbers below are **planning assumptions**. They should be replaced with BeReal's real baselines before launch.

Input	Assumption
Baseline active days per casual user (28 days)	Mean **6**, standard deviation **5**
Minimum detectable effect (MDE)	**+5% relative** (+0.3 active days)
Significance and power	α = 0.05 (two-sided), power = 80%
Average squad size	8 users
Correlation within squads (ICC)	0.05–0.10

Result	Per arm	Total
Users needed if individually randomized	~4,360	~8,700
Adjusted for squad randomization (×1.35–1.70)	**~5,900–7,400 users** (~740–930 squads)	**~12,000–15,000 users**

Duration: 8 weeks, with a 4-week minimum. Eight weeks covers **two full monthly board cycles**, shows whether interest fades after the novelty, and gives a clean day-30 retention read. The test runs its full length even if early results look good, so there's no stopping early.

Before launch:

- Run a 1-week **A/A test**, with both groups getting standard BeReal, to confirm the split and the tracking are sound.
- Check that the 50/50 split holds, with no sample-ratio mismatch, throughout the test.

Decision criteria

Outcome	Rule	Next step
✅ **Ship**	Primary metric lifts **≥ +5%** for casual users (statistically significant) **and** no guardrail is breached	Phase 3 full rollout
🔁 **Iterate**	Primary metric is positive but not significant, **or** board opt-in is below 15%, **or** a guardrail is close to its threshold	Fix onboarding or the flow, then rerun
❌ **Kill**	Primary metric's upper confidence bound is **below +2%**, **or** any guardrail is breached (e.g., regular posts drop more than 2%)	Stop; write up the learnings

Instrumentation

These events need to be tracked before Stage 2 can run:

Event	Fires when
`app_open`	The app opens; feeds the primary metric
`board_optin` / `board_optout`	A user joins or leaves a board, with the board ID
`post_type_selected`	The user picks `send` or `community_board`
`board_selected`	A board is chosen, with the board ID
`stamp_post_success` / `stamp_post_error`	Posting finishes, with taps and seconds since capture
`passport_view` / `stamp_tally_view` / `capsule_view`	Collection screens are opened
`reaction_sent`	A squad reaction is sent
`notification_disabled`	A notification setting is turned off

Threats to validity

Threat	Mitigation
Novelty effect: people try anything new	8-week run; compare week 1–2 with week 7–8
Spillover between friends	Randomize by squad, not by individual
Self-selection: opt-in users differ	Intent-to-treat analysis
Seasonality: some board themes are more appealing	Two full monthly cycles; the same calendar period for both groups
More notifications in the treatment group	Match notification volume in the control group
Peeking at results early	One primary metric chosen in advance; fixed duration

Timeline

Week	Activity
0	Stage 1 usability retest and design fixes
1–2	Build the MVP; add instrumentation; run the A/A test

Week	Activity
3–10	A/B experiment (8 weeks)
11	Analysis and readout; ship, iterate or kill decision

Readout template

1. **Decision:** ship, iterate or kill, in one line.
2. **Primary metric:** lift, confidence interval, p-value.
3. **Guardrails:** each one with its value, marked pass or fail.
4. **Secondary metrics and segments:** casual, daily and all users.
5. **What we learned** and **what we'd test next**.